

takes *cough*Brotherhood of Steel*cough*.

Even though it was fully 3D-rendered, had real-time combat, wasn't isometric, and was kind of an FPS, Fallout was back baby! It was designed on Oblivion's game engine, hence the familiarity between the two titles. S.P.E.C.I.A.L. was back, the karma system was back, perks and skills were back, whacky side quests were back, everything we loved had been included. V.A.T.S. (Vault-Tec Assisted Targeting System) was brought in for specific targeting and some bullet time epicness.

We were now in Washington DC, thirty-six years after Fallout 2. New Vault Dweller, new Vault 101. He's looking for his father who has suddenly disappeared. The Brotherhood of Steel and the Enclave are ready to duke it out and that's the least of your troubles. The Lone Wanderer could visit the other outposts, meet new people, kill them (you don't HAVE to, you can), help them, do whatever he or she wanted. There was of course quick travel, but why would you do that when there's so much to explore and do. After 10 years, Fallout finally had a worthy sequel. Fallout 3 went on to outsell all previous Fallout titles and is still played today with an active modding community.

Meanwhile Interplay wasn't doing too hot with the MMO, and Bethesda took them to court for being unable to meet the license agreement. But Bethesda weren't able to win and development continued. Interplay went on to announce a teaser site at E3 2010 where potential players could sign up for the beta but it never progressed beyond that. Bethesda settled with Interplay out of court and regained the Fallout MMO license.

Enter New Vegas

Fallout 3 was quickly followed by Obsidian Entertainment's Fallout:

New Vegas. Obsidian was of course, made up mostly of former Black Isle employees and so a lot of the folks who worked on Fallout 2 were here. Ideas from Fallout 2 and Van Buren were incorporated into New Vegas which would be a hybrid between the old and new fallout. However, the rushed release came with lots of bugs. It wasn't ready yet, thanks to which it got poor reviews. But after various patches, mods, and expansions, New Vegas could easily be on par, if not better than any of the previous Fallout titles.

New Vegas had you playing as The Courier, a messenger who was shot in the head and left for dead, with no memories but only revenge on your

system. The ability to build your own settlements, grow crops, build generators and defences. You know, actually tame the wasteland instead of the just wandering about. Also, the Sole Survivor would be fully voiced and the Xbox One version of the game would get mod support. What could go wrong?

Turns out too much hype is never a good thing. Not saying that Fallout 4 was a bad game but it didn't live up to the hype it created. The focus seemed to have moved from story to gameplay. It was more like an FPS than ever. Your decisions didn't feel as impactful and the plot – even though you were given choices to make – seemed linear. The end result was the

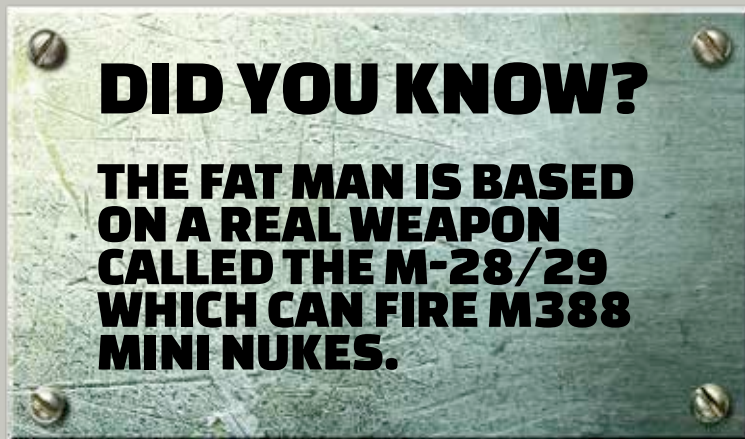
same no matter which approach you decided to take or which faction you decided to support. Considering that it's as recent as a year old we'll hold off on spoilers about the plot. We're considerate that way.

At its core though it was still a Fallout game. Despite its flaws it's still very much enjoyable. There's still those crazy weird side-

quests, quirky and memorable NPCs and companions, some ridiculous weapons, and hours upon hours of fun to be had. The crafting system is quite complex and there's many possibilities to weapon and armour modifications. And speaking of modifications, you can't forget about the modding community. You can count on them to fix anything the game developers may have overlooked. For all you know, maybe they do it intentionally so that the modders fix it for them.

Conclusion

Almost every title in this franchise has won a game of the year award. It's one of the few franchises out there that still does RPG right. Need we say more? If you're an RPG nut the Fallout experience is one you shouldn't miss at any cost. *



mind. It was a much more intricate storyline, lot's of politics and conflict, but Fallout to the core. There's of course no shortage of weirdness, wouldn't be a Fallout game without it. For example, there's a sniper perched on a dinosaur who you can recruit. There was lots more content added to the game as well, thanks to expansions and mods.

Took an awful lot of titles to be able to make a shack

Fallout 4 was swimming in hype. So many promises and from a company that has delivered and then some in the past. After the success of Skyrim in 2011, Bethesda could do no wrong, at least in the eyes of the fans. And Fallout 4 was going to be as amazing as they said it would be. There was going to be a fully fleshed crafting